EE-M-591C
March 15, 1972
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. EE-M-591B
April 2, 1963

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

MONOSODIUM GLUTAMATE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal Agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for crystalline monosodium glutamate, for use by agencies of the Federal Government.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495	-	Coatings Exterior for Tinned Food Cans.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-C-29	-	Canned Subsistence Items, Packaging and Packing of.
PPP-C-96	-	Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter.

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers, at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

FSC 8950

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items.
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit; Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-668 - Sanitary Standards for Food Plants.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Department of Health, Education and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.)

United States Department of Agriculture

United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Information Division, Consumer and Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, D.C., 20250.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N. W. Washington, D.C. 20036.)

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Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Finished product. The product shall be odorless, free flowing and may have either a slightly sweet or slightly salty flavor. The crystals shall be white, and translucent. It shall be the naturally occurring isomer form and optically active form of monosodium glutamate monohydrate, and shall be produced by the extraction of vegetable materials or by fermentation.

3.1.1 Purity. The average monosodium glutamate monohydrate content shall be not less than 99.0 percent. The purity determinations made on sample units from a lot shall be not less than 98.5 percent in any individual sample unit.

3.1.2 Moisture. The average moisture content of the product shall not exceed 0.25 percent.

3.1.3 Salt. The salt content shall be not more than 0.4 percent by weight (calculated as NaCl).

3.2 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.3 Workmanship. The product shall be prepared, processed and packaged under modern sanitary conditions and in accordance with good commercial practice. For military agencies, the product shall be processed in establishments meeting the requirements of MIL-STD-668.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Sampling. Samples of finished products covered by this specification and samples of any materials, components, or constituents entering into the preparation of the finished products may be taken at any time by the Government inspector to determine compliance with the requirements.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 General. Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative, at the time and place designated by the

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procuring agency. It may be made at the site of manufacture, both during and after processing, at any suitable point in transit, or after delivery to the point of destination.

4.2.2 Factory inspection. The passing as satisfactory of any detail of processing or materials shall not relieve the supplier of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.3 Final inspection. Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination (see 6.6 and 6.7).

4.2.4 Condition inspection of containers. When inspection of product for quality and condition is performed by the U.S. Department of Agriculture, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers shall apply. (For criteria governing inspection of containers for the military agencies, see 4.2.7.2).

4.2.5 Responsibility for inspection. The supplier is responsible for meeting all the provisions of the specification prior to submission of supplies to the Government for acceptance. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is required to perform the examination and tests prescribed herein, using his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government.

4.2.5.1 Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be complete and made available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2.6 Preacceptance inspection (plant sanitation inspection).

4.2.6.1 Civil agencies. When specified (see 6.1), inspection of plants producing the product will be conducted upon the request of the contracting officer to the appropriate Government inspection agency. Award of contracts will be limited to establishments known to maintain proper sanitary conditions or which have received prior sanitary approval recommended by the inspection agency.

4.2.6.2 Military agencies. Product shall be rejected if produced in plants not meeting the requirements of 3.3.

4.2.7 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2.7.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.2.5 and 4.2.5.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance

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with requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.7.1.1 Testing of cans. Cans as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be tested for tin plate in accordance with 4.3.3. The test requirement shall be an average requirement. The sample unit for testing shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-1. Lot size shall be expressed in cans. Test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.01 lb/base box. Test for can coating and can label shall be performed on the cans submitted for tin plate testing. A test failure shall indicate unacceptable cans and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved end item.

4.2.7.2 Examination of end item. Examinations shall be in accordance with tables II through V and 4.2.7.2.1 through 4.2.7.2.5. The sampling plans for the aforementioned tables shall be in accordance with table I. The acceptable quality levels (AQLs) shall be expressed as defects per hundred units for tables II, IV, and V, and percent defective for table III.

TABLE I. Sampling plans

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQLs		
				Major	Minor	Total
II	I	1 filled and closed primary container	Primary containers	1.5	-	6.5
III	S-3	1 filled primary container	Primary containers	-	2.5	-
IV	S-2	1 filled primary container	Primary containers	1.5	-	-
V	S-3	1 filled and closed intermediate container	Intermediate containers	4.0	-	-

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TABLE II. Examination of level C packages

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	Cans
101		Not one of styles specified
102		Dredge style opening (when supplied) inoperable
103		Sifter (hole, cut or open seam)
104		Plug in "plug top" can insecure or missing
	201	Severe dent
	202	Not clean 1/
105		Pitted rust 2/
		Glass Containers
106		Broken, cracked, chipped or thin spot
107		Cap insecure 3/
108		Pitted rust on cap 2/
	203	Cross threaded
	204	Not clean
		Fiber Cans
	205	Not spirally wound
113		Tear, hole, open seam, sifter
114		Pour opening of fiber can inoperative
115		Not clean
116		Pitted rust on ends of fiber cans (if ends are metal) 2/
		Label
117		Label missing
118		Nomenclature missing, incorrect or illegible
	206	Other required information missing, incorrect or illegible

1/ Cans showing a very thin film of grease which is discernible to the touch but not readily discernible visually are considered to be clean.

2/ Rust that can be removed by wiping with a soft cloth shall not be considered pitted rust.

3/ For determining secureness of screw cap closure, the following is applicable: Place the container upright on top of a filled and closed fiberboard box. Grasp the sides of the cap firmly with fingertips and turn cap gently counter-clockwise with a minimum of downward pressure to one complete revolution. If cap turns and the container remains stationary, a defect shall be scored.

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TABLE III. Examination for net weight 1/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Net weight less than 108 grams (for 4-ounce container)
202	Less than 15½ ounces (for 1-pound container)

1/ Report results to nearest gram for 4-ounce container and nearest 1/8 ounce for 1-pound container. Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicates a lot average net weight less than required net weight.

TABLE IV. Examination of product 1/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Not white and translucent crystals
102	Not free flowing
103	Not odorless
104	Not basically tasteless 2/

1/ Presence of foreign material (e.g. filth, insects, glass, wood, metal, paint, etc.) shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ A slightly sweet or slightly salty taste shall not be scored as a defect.

TABLE V. Examination of intermediate containers

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Not type of container specified
102	Not securely closed with gummed kraft tape or adhesive
103	Nomenclature on container missing, incorrect or illegible
104	Partitions for glass containers missing, not as specified, or not providing a snug-fitting cell for each glass container

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4.2.7.2.1 Examination of level A cans. Examination of level A cans (hermetically sealed cans) for external condition, seam leakage and interior enamel shall be in accordance with the applicable quality assurance provisions of PPP-C-29.

4.2.7.2.2 Examination of can coating. Examination of can coating for level A cans shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of TT-C-495.

4.2.7.2.3 Examination of can label. Examination of can label for level A cans shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-1497.

4.2.7.2.4 Examination of shipping containers. The filled and closed shipping containers shall be examined in accordance with the quality assurance provisions in the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be included in the examination: Major - Required marking missing, incorrect or illegible; Minor - Number or arrangement of contents not as required. For level C pack, as specified in 5.2.3.1, only the aforementioned defects pertaining to markings, and number and arrangement of contents shall apply.

4.2.7.2.5 Examination of unit loads. Unit loads shall be examined in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

4.2.7.3 Testing of finished product. The finished product shall be tested for purity, moisture and salt in accordance with 4.3. Test requirements for purity shall be unit and average requirements. Test requirements for moisture and salt content shall be average requirements. The sample unit for purity (unit requirement) shall be 1 ounce of product derived from a primary container. The sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-2. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of the primary container. The acceptable quality level shall be 2.5 expressed as percent defective. The sample for moisture, salt, and purity (average requirement) shall be a 3-ounce composite derived from the aforementioned sample units. Each test result shall be reported to the same unit or decimal place as specified for the pertinent requirement. A test failure for any of the average requirement tests shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3 Test methods. Examination and test procedures which differ from those specified herein, unless otherwise excepted, may be used by the supplier if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government contracting officer determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum such quality assurance, the supplier will use the procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to examination or test results, the procedures specified herein will govern.

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4.3.1 Examination procedures.

4.3.1.1 Examination for leakage. The procedure for determining seam leakage of cans shall be in accordance with PPP-C-29.

4.3.2 Test procedures.

4.3.2.1 Moisture. Moisture shall be determined as follows: weigh 2 g of the product into a covered dish. Place the cover lightly on the dish and dry in a vacuum oven at 85°C for 3 hours. Cover the dish tightly, cool in a desiccator, and weigh.

4.3.2.2 Salt. The following method for the determination of salt, as NaCl, shall be used:

Reagents;

Silver nitrate solution. Weigh accurately 14.53 g of c.p. silver nitrate. Dissolve in distilled water and dilute to 1000 ml (1 ml of this solution is equivalent to 0.005 g NaCl).

Potassium-thiocyanate solution. Weigh roughly 10 g potassium thiocyanate and dilute to 1000 ml with distilled water.

Indicator. Saturated solution of ferric ammonium sulfate (ferric alum).

Standardization of potassium thiocyanate. Measure exactly 10 ml of the silver nitrate solution into a flask. Dilute with 100 ml distilled water. Add 10 ml of concentrated HNO_3 and 5 ml of ferric alum solution. Titrate with the thiocyanate solution to the appearance of a permanent salmon pink color. On the basis of this titration, dilute the thiocyanate solution so that 1 ml is exactly equivalent to 1 ml of the silver nitrate solution. The thiocyanate solution should be checked against the silver nitrate solution frequently (at least once each week).

Determination of salt in monosodium glutamate. Weigh exactly 1 g of monosodium glutamate and place in a glass-stoppered flask. Dilute with about 100 ml distilled water and add 10 ml concentrated nitric acid. Add a measured excess of silver nitrate solution (usually 10 ml is sufficient). Insert stopper and shake the flask. Add 5 ml ferric alum solution and titrate the excess of silver nitrate with the thiocyanate solution. The difference between the amount of silver nitrate solution and amount of thiocyanate used represents amount of silver nitrate reacting with chloride. Each cc of silver nitrate used equals 0.5 percent NaCl.

4.3.2.3 Purity. Purity shall be determined as follows: A 5-gram sample is dissolved in 100 ml of water and the pH determined on a pH meter. If the pH is below or above 7, the solution is titrated potentiometrically

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to exactly 7 with either N/10 NaOH or N/10 H_2SO_4, and the number of ml of base or acid recorded. Another 5-gram sample is titrated potentiometrically directly on the dry powder with normal H_2SO_4 to pH 3.2. One-tenth the number of milliliters of N/10 base or acid used to bring the pH of the first sample to pH7 is added to or subtracted from, respectively, the number of milliliters of N H_2SO_4 required for titrating the second 5 g sample, thus giving the net number of milliliters of N H_2SO_4 required to reduce the pH from 7 to 3.2. The molecular weight of monosodium glutamate containing one molecule of water of crystallization being 187, the purity is given by the following equation:

$$\text{Percent purity} = \frac{\text{ml N } H_2SO_4 \times 0.187 \times 100}{5} = \text{ml N } H_2SO_4 \times 3.74$$

4.3.3 Tin coating weights. Tin coating weights shall be determined by any method specified in PPP-C-96.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Four ounce hermetically sealed can. Four ounces of the product shall be filled into an open-top style, round, metal can with soldered side seam and compound-lined, double-seamed ends. The cans shall be made throughout from not less than commercial 0.25 pound per base box electrolytic tin plate (see 4.3.3). The cans shall be coated inside with an enamel or lacquer provided by the can manufacturer in accordance with best commercial practice for the specific product being packed. The cans shall be coated outside with a coating conforming to type I or II of TT-C-495. The cans shall be hermetically sealed and shall not show leakage when examined in accordance with 4.3.1.1.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.2.1 or 5.1.2.2, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.2.1 Hermetically sealed can. The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1.1, except that cans with or without a commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.1.2.2 Commercial package. Four ounces or 1-pound of the product as specified (see 6.1) shall be packaged in a slip covered style, rectangular metal can with locked side seams and clinched on ends, in a spirally wound fiber container, or in a glass container. The cans shall be equipped either with a plug-type opening and deep, tight-fitting plug or a tight-fitting sift-and-pour, dredge-style opening of the sliding or revolving type. When specified (see 6.1), the 4-ounce packages shall be overpacked in intermediate shipping containers as specified in 5.1.2.2.1.

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5.1.2.2.1 Intermediate shipping container. Twelve four-ounce packages of the product, packaged as specified in 5.1.2.2, shall be overpacked in a snug-fitting fiberboard box. The flaps of the box shall be sealed with gummed kraft tape or a good grade commercial adhesive. When product is packaged in glass containers, the intermediate container shall be provided with fiberboard partitions which provide a snug-fitting cell for each glass container.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A, hermetically sealed cans. Forty-eight cans of the product, packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be packed on end in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, V2s, of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B, hermetically sealed cans. Forty-eight cans of the product, packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be packed on end in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, V3c, V3s, or V4s, of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.1 and 6.4), the shipping container specified in 5.2.2 shall be reinforced with pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. Forty-eight hermetically sealed cans of the product packaged as specified in 5.1.2.1, 48 4-ounce packages packed as specified in 5.1.2.2, 12 1-pound containers packaged as specified in 5.1.2.2 or 6 intermediate containers of commercial packages as specified in 5.1.2.2.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, type CF or SF, class domestic, method II closure of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3.1 When specified (see 6.1 and 6.5), the shipping container shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.2.4 When specified (see 6.1), shipping containers of the product shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies.

5.3.1.1 Labeling. For unit containers any commercial labeling or additional labeling, as specified, that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder, is acceptable.

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5.3.1.2 Shipping containers. Unless otherwise specified, marking shall be in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.3.2 Military agencies.

5.3.2.1 Labeling. Hermetically sealed cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. For containers other than hermetically sealed cans, labeling in accordance with 5.3.1.1 will be acceptable.

5.3.2.2 Intermediate shipping container. The name of the product shall appear on the intermediate shipping container.

5.3.2.3 Marking of shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.3 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) When preacceptance inspection for civil agencies is required (see 4.2.6.1).
(c) Packaging and packing levels (5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Type of level C packaging required (see 5.1.2).
(e) Size of container required for level C commercial package (see 5.1.2.2).
(f) When overpacking is required for 4-ounce commercial packages (see 5.1.2.2).
(g) When packing specified in 5.2.2.1 or 5.2.3.1 is required.
(h) Type and class of unit load required when unit loading is specified (see 5.2.4).

6.2 If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.3 Based on conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15.

6.4 Packing specified in 5.2.2.1 is intended for transfer at sea operation or specific overseas operations.

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6.5 Packing specified in 5.2.3.1 is intended for direct shipment from the supply source to the consumer for immediate use within CONUS.

6.6 Supplier's inspection. The supplier should be required to assure the product conforms to the specification prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.7 Destination inspection (for civil agencies only). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition identity and quality only.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8950-0082

Review activities:

Army - MD
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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
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INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION

MONOSODIUM GLUTAMATE EE-M-591C

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 65 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64 WHICH MAY BE USED.

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